emphasis on time and space complexity (big O notation).

This shift is especially apparent in React-focused interviews, where candidates are often tasked with hands-on projects, such as implementing a star rating component, similar to Jane's experience. These tasks are designed to assess proficiency in React fundamentals, including state management, hooks, and component architecture, as well as UI/UX considerations, code organization and reusability, user interaction handling, and accessibility. Once the candidate completes the task, interviewers also evaluate their approach to testing, consideration of edge cases, handling of both happy and failure paths, graceful error handling, and model design.

For senior-level positions—and increasingly for junior roles—a system design round may be included to evaluate a candidate's ability to architect complex frontend systems. A behavioral round is also common, assessing soft skills and cultural fit through questions about past experiences and collaboration. In some cases, an executive may participate in the process to promote the company to the candidate, which could be a separate sell call. The process concludes with a final decision, where the hiring team reviews all feedback and determines whether to extend an offer.

It is important to note that while this structure is common, the interview process may vary between companies. This book is designed to be an all-encompassing guide for frontend developers like Jane, thoroughly preparing them for the challenges of securing a position in the field. While the initial screening and final decision stages are often personalized, the focus is on equipping candidates for the critical screening interview and full loop stages, directly addressing coding rounds, system design interviews, and behavioral assessments.

For frontend interviews, it is essential to begin with a solid understanding of the fundamentals of HTML, CSS, and JavaScript or TypeScript—the core technologies that power the web. Building on this foundation, candidates should then develop a deep knowledge of modern frameworks like React, including its key concepts and broader ecosystem. This approach ensures that candidates are not only able to write code proficiently but also understand and articulate the underlying principles, allowing them to explain concepts in depth during interviews.